

Case Study: School Threat Detection System

Business Case

The School Threat Detection System is an AI-powered security platform leveraging computer vision and object detection to monitor live camera feeds across school premises. The system identifies potential threats, such as weapons or suspicious objects, in real-time to enhance campus safety and enable rapid response. It aims to reduce incident response times, ensure compliance with privacy laws, and integrate with existing school security infrastructure.

Scale

For scale, consider a school district with 50 schools, each equipped with 20–50 cameras, processing live feeds concurrently. The system must handle multiple schools, cameras, and alerts with high reliability and low latency.

High-Level Goals

- **Outcome:** Accurate and timely detection of threats with minimal false positives, ensuring rapid alerts to security personnel.
- **Scalability:** Support multiple schools and cameras concurrently with modular, extensible architecture.
- **Quality:** High detection accuracy, reliable alert delivery, and robust error handling with retries for failed processes.
- **Security:** Ensure data privacy, compliance with regulations (e.g., FERPA, GDPR), and secure data transmission.
- **Multi-Tenant Support:** Logical separation of data for different schools or districts.
- **Observability & Reliability:** Real-time monitoring, logging, and rollback capabilities for failed detections or alerts.

System & Architecture Design

Design a scalable, modular architecture for an AI-powered School Threat Detection System. The architecture must support multi-tenancy for multiple schools or districts and integrate with existing security systems.

Create a:

1. High-level system diagram.
2. List of key services and components.
3. Outline of data flow.

System Requirements

- **Functional:**
 - Process live video feeds from multiple cameras in real-time.
 - Detect predefined threat objects (e.g., firearms, knives) using AI-based object detection.

- Send real-time alerts via email, SMS, or dashboard to designated personnel.
- Provide a user interface for security personnel to monitor feeds and alerts.
- Log all detections and alerts for auditing and compliance.
- **Non-Functional:**
 - Low latency: Detect threats and send alerts within seconds.
 - High availability: 99.9% uptime for continuous monitoring.
 - Scalability: Handle thousands of camera feeds across multiple schools.
 - Security: Encrypt video feeds and ensure compliance with privacy laws.
 - Reliability: Retry failed detections or alerts and maintain audit logs.

Key Considerations

- **Privacy:** Avoid facial recognition or individual identification to comply with ethical and legal standards.
- **Accuracy:** Balance sensitivity to detect threats with specificity to minimize false alarms.
- **Integration:** Seamlessly integrate with existing camera systems and security protocols.
- **Orchestration:** Manage distributed processing of video feeds across multiple cameras and schools.
- **Observability:** Provide dashboards and logs for monitoring system health and threat detection performance.